

As an appointed analyst, you test samples of imported food. This is part of our [Imported Food Inspection Scheme](#).

This guide sets out:

- units of measurement to use when reporting results
- minimum performance required of any testing methodology (limit of reporting)
- how to report the results of analysis.

Appointed analysts must have National Association of Testing Authorities (NATA) or International Accreditation New Zealand (IANZ) accreditation for the food/analyte combination you are testing.

You must comply with the [conditions for appointment as an analyst](#).

Imports referred for testing

All imports into Australia are lodged with the [Department of Home Affairs' Integrated Cargo System \(ICS\)](#).

Certain entries lodged with ICS will be identified as requiring inspection. The ICS will send the details to our Agriculture Import Management System (AIMS).

We issue an Imported Food Inspection Report (IFIR) for the food we inspect and test.

Importers choose a laboratory

Importers choose a laboratory when their food imports are being tested. They submit a nomination form directly to a laboratory.

When you receive a nomination form, complete the 'Laboratory use only' section and send it to our [regional office](#) near you.

The importer can then book their inspection.

Collecting samples

Our officers collect a representative sample when they inspect the imported food. The sample may be a single unit per lot or multiple sub-samples per lot.

We place samples in a tamper evident bag with a unique barcode. The barcode will be placed on the IFIR which must accompany the sample bag to the appointed analyst.

AIMS contains information from the IFIR. The IFIR records:

- what food is to be held or released
- information to identify the sampled food

- what tests will be applied.

Receiving samples

We will send you an electronic IFIR (eIFIR) when samples are ready for collection. You must arrange for a courier to collect the samples from the collection point.

A copy of the IFIR will be attached to the food sample you receive.

Contact the relevant [regional office](#) if the IFIR:

- is not included with the sample
- is incomplete or illegible
- does not match the barcode on the food sample.

Testing samples

Complete the tests on the food sample listed on the IFIR.

Where compositing is permitted in specific tests, take sub-samples of equal mass or volume from each of the original samples to form the composite sample for analysis.

If the sample receives a failing result, follow the [confirmatory testing requirements](#) before reporting the result.

Adulteration of honey with C4 sugars

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
ADULTHNY	Adulteration with C4 sugars	Not required/ 1 result	%	Not applicable

Aflatoxin

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
		Permitted/		
AFLAT	Aflatoxin	1 result	mg/kg	0.004

Arsenic (total)

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
		Permitted/		
ARSENICT	Arsenic (total)	1 result	mg/kg	1

Cannabidiol

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/ No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
CANNA	Cannabidiol	Permitted/ 1 result	mg/kg	0.5

Carbon monoxide

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/ No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
CO	Carbon monoxide	Permitted/ 1 result	mg/kg	0.2

Cephalosporins

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
CEPHALO	Ceftiofur	Permitted/1 result	mg/kg	0.1

Domoic acid

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
DOMOIC	Domoic acid	Permitted/ 1 result	mg/kg	2

Fluoroquinolones Note: 1 result for each of the analytes listed below is required, with exception of Levofloxacin and Ofloxacin, which is to be reported as one result.

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/ No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
FLUORO	Ciprofloxacin	Permitted / 1 result for each of the chemicals listed	mg/ kg	0.002
	Enrofloxacin			
	Gatifloxacin			
	Moxifloxacin			
	Norfloxacin			
	Sarafloxacin			
	sum of Levofloxacin and Ofloxacin			

Note: 1 result for each of the analytes listed below is required, with exception of Levofloxacin and Ofloxacin, which is to be reported as one result.

Histamine

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
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Permitted/

HISTA	Histamine	1 result	mg/kg	20
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Hydrocyanic acid

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
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Permitted/

HCN	Hydrocyanic acid	1 result	mg/kg	5
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Inorganic arsenic Note: report ‘at 85% hydration’ in the ‘test methods’ field

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
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INORG	Inorganic arsenic	Permitted/ 1 result	mg/kg at 85% hydration	0.1
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Note: report ‘at 85% hydration’ in the ‘test methods’ field

Iodine Note: report ‘dry weight’ in the ‘test methods’ field

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
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IODINE	Iodine	Permitted/ 1 result	mg/kg dry weight	0.1
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Note: report ‘dry weight’ in the ‘test methods’ field

Lead

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
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Permitted/

LEAD	Lead	1 result	mg/kg	0.1
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Malachite green

Test Code	Analytes	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
MALAG	Malachite green Leuco-malachite green	Permitted /1 result for each of the chemicals listed	mg/ kg	0.002

Moisture content

Test Code	Analytes	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
		Not required/ 1 result		
MOISTHNY	Moisture content		%	Not applicable

Nitrofurans Note: Soft shell crab with an initial nitrofurantoin semicarbazide (SEM) result at or above the LOR of 0.001mg/kg, requires a secondary test of the inner portions (meat only) to be analysed and reported.

Test Code	Analytes	Composite/ No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
		Permitted / 1 result for		
NITROFU	Furazolidone (AOZ)	each of the chemicals listed	mg/ kg	0.001
	Furaltadone (AMOZ)		mg/ kg	0.001
	Nitrofurantoin (AHD)		mg/ kg	0.001
	Nitrofurazone (SEM)		mg/ kg	0.001

Note: Soft shell crab with an initial nitrofurantoin semicarbazide (SEM) result at or above the LOR of 0.001mg/kg, requires a secondary test of the inner portions (meat only) to be analysed and reported.

Paralytic shellfish poison

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
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PSP	Paralytic shellfish poison	Permitted/ 1 result	mg/ kg	0.8
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Quinolones

Test Code	Analytes	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
QUINO	Flumequine Oxolinic acid	Permitted 1 result for each of the chemicals listed	mg/ kg	0.002

Reducing sugars content

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
SUGARHNY	Reducing sugars content	Not required/ 1 result	%	Not applicable

Total THC (tetrahydrocannabinol)

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
THC	Total THC	Permitted / 1 result	mg/ kg	0.5

Virginiamycin

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
VIRGN	Virginiamycin	Permitted/ 1 result	mg/kg	0.1

Compositing not permitted

One result required for a liquid sample (at least 100ml)

Five results required for powder samples (at least 100g per sample)

Test code: ALLEGEND

Allergen - dairy milk

Results to be reported	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
Beta-lactoglobulin	Not permitted/1 result for liquid and 5 results for powder	ppm	0.1

Casein (expressed as skim milk powder)	Not permitted/1 result for liquid and 5 results for powder	ppm	1.0
Total milk (expressed as non-fat dried milk)	Not permitted/1 result for liquid and 5 results for powder	ppm	2.5

Portion of the commodity prepared for testing must be as per [Schedule 22](#) (Foods and classes of foods) of the Food Standards Code (see statements under each commodity in the schedule which describe the ‘Portion of the commodity to which the MRL applies’).

Compositing permitted.

Reporting requirements:

Where all residues are below the LOR, report an analysis result as per the table.

Analysis to be reported Units Results of analysis

All residues <LOR mg/kg < LOR

All-analytes mg/kg < LOR

Where residues are detected equal to or greater than the LOR, report an analysis result as per the following table. Include the measurement uncertainty (MU) in mg/kg in the ‘Results of analysis’ field directly after the analysis result. Report to one significant figure.

Analysis to be reported Units Results of analysis

Residues <LOR except mg/kg < LOR

<<analyte>> mg/kg <<result>> MU<<result>>

e.g. bifenthrin mg/kg 0.16 MU 0.02

Test code: FVRES

Analytes to be reported	FSC 1.4.2 Residue definition	Units	Limit of reporting
2-phenylphenol	sum of 2-phenylphenol and 2-phenylphenate	mg/kg	0.05
acephate		mg/kg	0.05
aldrin and dieldrin	sum of HHDN and HEOD	mg/kg	0.05
azinphos-methyl		mg/kg	0.05
azoxystrobin		mg/kg	0.05
benalaxyl			0.05

		mg/ kg	
bifenthrin		mg/ kg	0.01
bioresmethrin		mg/ kg	0.05
bitertanol		mg/ kg	0.05
boscalid		mg/ kg	0.05
captan		mg/ kg	0.05
carbaryl		mg/ kg	0.1
carbendazim	sum of carbendazim and 2-aminobenzimidazole	mg/ kg	0.05
chlorfenvinphos	sum of E and Z isomers	mg/ kg	0.05
chlorothalonil		mg/ kg	0.05
chlorpyrifos		mg/ kg	0.01
chlorpyrifos-methyl		mg/ kg	0.05
chlorthal-dimethyl		mg/ kg	0.05
cyfluthrin	sum of isomers	mg/ kg	0.05
cyhalothrin	sum of isomers	mg/ kg	0.01
cypermethrin	sum of isomers	mg/ kg	0.05
cyproconazole	sum of isomers	mg/ kg	0.05
cyprodinil		mg/ kg	0.05
DDT	sum of p,p DDT; o,p DDT; p,p DDE and p,p DDD	mg/ kg	0.05

deltamethrin		mg/ kg	0.05
diazinon		mg/ kg	0.05
dichlorvos		mg/ kg	0.05
dicloran		mg/ kg	0.05
dicofol	sum of dicofol and 2,2,2-trichloro-1-(4-chlorophenyl)-1-(2-chlorophenyl)ethanol	mg/ kg	0.1
difenoconazole		mg/ kg	0.05
dimethoate	sum of dimethoate and omethoate	mg/ kg	0.02
dimethomorph	sum of E and Z isomers	mg/ kg	0.05
diphenylamine		mg/ kg	0.05
disulfoton	sum of disulfoton and demeton-S and their sulfoxides and sulfones	mg/ kg	0.05
diuron	sum of diuron and 3,4- dichloroaniline	mg/ kg	0.05
endosulfan	sum of A- and B- endosulfan and endosulfan sulphate	mg/ kg	0.05
endrin		mg/ kg	0.05
ethoprofos		mg/ kg	0.05
fenamiphos	sum of fenamiphos, its sulfoxide and sulfone	mg/ kg	0.05
fenarimol		mg/ kg	0.05
fenhexamid		mg/ kg	0.02
fenitrothion		mg/ kg	0.01
fenoxycarb		mg/ kg	0.05
fenpyroximate			0.05

		mg/ kg	
fenthion	sum of fenthion, its oxygen analogue, and their sulfoxides and sulfones	mg/ kg	0.05
fenvalerate	sum of isomers	mg/ kg	0.05
fipronil	sum of fipronil, the sulphenyl metabolite, the sulphonyl metabolite and the trifluoromethyl metabolite	mg/ kg	0.05
fludioxonil		mg/ kg	0.02
flusilazole		mg/ kg	0.05
HCB (hexachlorobenzene)		mg/ kg	0.05
HCH (BHC)	sum of isomers of 1,2,3,4,5,6-hexachlorocyclohexane other than lindane (gamma-HCH)	mg/ kg	0.05
heptachlor	sum of heptachlor and heptachlor epoxide	mg/ kg	0.01
hexaconazole		mg/ kg	0.05
hexythiazox		mg/ kg	0.05
imazalil		mg/ kg	0.05
indoxacarb	sum of indoxacarb and its R-isomer	mg/ kg	0.05
iprodione		mg/ kg	0.05
kresoxsim-methyl		mg/ kg	0.05
lindane		mg/ kg	0.05
linuron	sum of linuron and 3,4- dichloroaniline	mg/ kg	0.05
malathion (maldison)		mg/ kg	0.05
metalaxyl		mg/ kg	0.05

methamidophos		mg/ kg	0.05
methidathion		mg/ kg	0.01
methomyl		mg/ kg	0.02
mevinphos		mg/ kg	0.05
monocrotophos		mg/ kg	0.05
myclobutanil		mg/ kg	0.05
oxyfluorfen		mg/ kg	0.05
paclobutrazol		mg/ kg	0.01
parathion-ethyl		mg/ kg	0.05
parathion-methyl		mg/ kg	0.05
penconazole		mg/ kg	0.05
pendimethalin		mg/ kg	0.05
permethrin	sum of isomers	mg/ kg	0.05
phenothrin	sum of (+)cis- and (+)trans-isomers	mg/ kg	0.05
phorate	sum of phorate, its oxygen analogue, and their sulfoxides and sulfones	mg/ kg	0.05
phosmet	sum of phosmet and its oxygen analogue	mg/ kg	0.05
piperonyl-butoxide		mg/ kg	0.05
pirimicarb	sum of pirimicarb, demethyl-pirimicarb, demethylformamido-pirimicarb	mg/ kg	0.05
pirimiphos-methyl		mg/ kg	0.05
procymidone			0.02

		mg/ kg	
profenofos		mg/ kg	0.05
propargite		mg/ kg	0.05
propiconazole		mg/ kg	0.05
prothiofos		mg/ kg	0.05
pymetrozine		mg/ kg	0.02
pyraclostrobin		mg/ kg	0.05
pyrethrins	sum of pyrethrins i and ii, cinerins i and ii and jasmolins i and ii	mg/ kg	0.1
pyrimethanil		mg/ kg	0.05
pyriproxyfen		mg/ kg	0.05
quintozene		mg/ kg	0.05
spinosad	sum of spinosyn A and spinosyn D	mg/ kg	0.02
spirotetramat	sum of spirotetramat and cis-3-(2,5-dimethylphenyl)-4-hydroxy-8-methoxy-1-azaspiro[4.5]dec-3-en-2-one	mg/ kg	0.02
tau-fluvalinate	sum of isomers	mg/ kg	0.05
tebuconazole		mg/ kg	0.05
tebufenozide		mg/ kg	0.05
tebufenpyrad		mg/ kg	0.05
terbufos	sum of terbufos, its oxygen analogue, and their sulfoxides and sulfones	mg/ kg	0.05
tetradifon		mg/ kg	0.05

thiabendazole		mg/ kg	0.02
thiacloprid		mg/ kg	0.05
thiamethoxam		mg/ kg	0.02
triadimefon	sum of triadimefon and triadimenol	mg/ kg	0.05
triadimenol		mg/ kg	0.05
trichlorfon		mg/ kg	0.05
trifloxystrobin	sum of trifloxystrobin and its acid metabolite ((E,E)-methoxyimino-[2-[1-(3-trifluoromethylphenyl)-ethylideneaminooxymethyl]phenyl] acetic acid)	mg/ kg	0.05
vinclozolin		mg/ kg	0.05

**Bacillus cereus
– tofu**

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
BCERE	Bacillus cereus	Not permitted/ 5 results	cfu/g	Enumerate result for each sample. Report to at least 100 E.g.: <100, 1300, <100, 3000, <100

**Coagulase–positive
staphylococci – seafood**

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
STAPH	Staphylococci	Not permitted/ 5 results	cfu/g	Enumerate result for each sample. Report to at least 100 E.g.: <100, 1300, <100, 3000, <100

**Cronobacter- powdered
infant formula**

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
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CRON	Cronobacter	If not composited/ 10 results	/10g	Detected 'D' or Not Detected 'ND' in each of the 10 samples. E.g.: ND, ND, ND, D, ND, ND, D, ND, ND, D
		If composited/ 1 result	/100g	Detected 'D' or Not Detected 'ND' in the composite sample. E.g.: ND

**Escherichia coli (E. coli) –
bivalve molluscs, marinara
mix**

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
ECOLI	E. coli	Not permitted/ 5 results	MPN/ g	Enumerate result for each sample. Report to at least 2.3 E.g.: <2.3, 45, <2.3, 45, <2.3

**Escherichia coli (E. coli) –
dried berries and dried
pomegranate arils**

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
ECOLI	E. coli	Not permitted/ 5 results	cfu/g	Enumerate result for each sample. Report to at least 100 E.g.: <100, <100, 1500, 120, 500

**Escherichia coli (E. coli) –
vegetables, beef and beef
products**

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
ECOLI	E. coli	Not permitted/ 5 results	cfu/g	Enumerate result for each sample. Report to at least 10 E.g.: <10, <10, 10, 120, <10

**Listeria monocytogenes – food in
which growth can occur* (risk
cheese, bivalve molluscs, cooked**

crustaceans, fungi, some meat products and some ready to eat finfish)

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/ No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
LIST	Listeria monocytogenes	If not composited/ 5 results	/25g	Detected 'D' or Not Detected 'ND' in each of the 5 samples. E.g.: ND, ND, ND, D, ND
		If composited/ 1 result	/125g	Detected 'D' or Not Detected 'ND' in the composite sample. E.g.: ND

* According to the [criteria](#) for each food

Listeria monocytogenes – food in which growth will not occur* (surveillance cheese, some meat products, cooked crustaceans, some ready-to-eat heat treated bivalve molluscs and some ready to eat finfish)

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/ No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
LISTQ	Listeria monocytogenes	Not permitted/ 5 results	cfu/g	Enumerate result for each sample. Report to at least 100. E.g.: <100, 100, <100, <100, 200

* According to the [criteria](#) for each food

Salmonella – cheese, crustaceans, dried herbs, marinara mix, meat products, pepper, spices, sesame seeds, dried milk and products containing sesame

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/ No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
SALM	Salmonella	If not composited/ 5 results	/25g	Detected 'D' or Not Detected 'ND' in each of the 5 samples. E.g.: ND, ND, ND, D, ND
		If composited/ 1 result	/125g	Detected 'D' or Not Detected 'ND' in the composite sample. E.g.: ND

Salmonella – coconut, powdered infant formula, follow-on formula

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
SALM	Salmonella	If not composited/ 10 results	/25g	Detected 'D' or Not Detected 'ND' in each of the 10 samples. E.g.: ND, ND, ND, D, ND, ND, D, ND, ND, D
		If composited/ 1 result	/250g	Detected 'D' or Not Detected 'ND' in the composite sample. E.g.: ND

Shiga toxin – producing Escherichia coli (E. coli) (STEC) – fresh (chilled or frozen) beef and beef products

Test Code	Analyte	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
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(For each analyte:
Detected ‘D’ or Not
Detected ‘ND’ for
example)

STEC	O26	Composited / 1 result for each analyte	/375g	ND
	O45			ND
	O103			ND
	O111			ND
	O121			ND
	O145			ND
	O157			ND

**Vibrio cholerae –
crustaceans**

Test Code	Analytes	Composite/No. of results	Units	Limit of reporting
VCHOL	Vibrio cholerae	If not composited/ 5 results	/25g	Detected ‘D’ or Not Detected ‘ND’ in each of the 5 samples. E.g.: ND, ND, ND, D, ND
		If composited/ 1 result	/125g	Detected ‘D’ or Not Detected ‘ND’ in the composite sample. E.g.: ND

Report the results

Refer to the details in the IFIR.

Use eResults to report the results to the AIMS system. This information will appear in the AIMS Test and Results Details screen.

Upload attachments as formatted XML.

We will use the results to determine if the food is a ‘pass’ or ‘fail’.

Inputting data into eResults

Test Code / Analytes: use the test code or the analyte name in its entirety when reporting to e-Results. Do not use any other abbreviation or code.

Composite / No. of results: this indicates where compositing is permitted and the number of results that must be entered into e-Results for each analyte.

Units: enter results using the units specified for each test. You may need to convert the results to the units specified.

Limit of reporting (LOR): for chemical testing, report any result less than the LOR as '<' the specified figure.

For microbiological results, the LOR is not necessarily the same as the food standard for the test.

If we identify results not being reported correctly, we may request you to resubmit the results. We will note the non-compliance and consider it during your appointment review.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/goods/food/appointed-analysts/testing-reporting-guide>